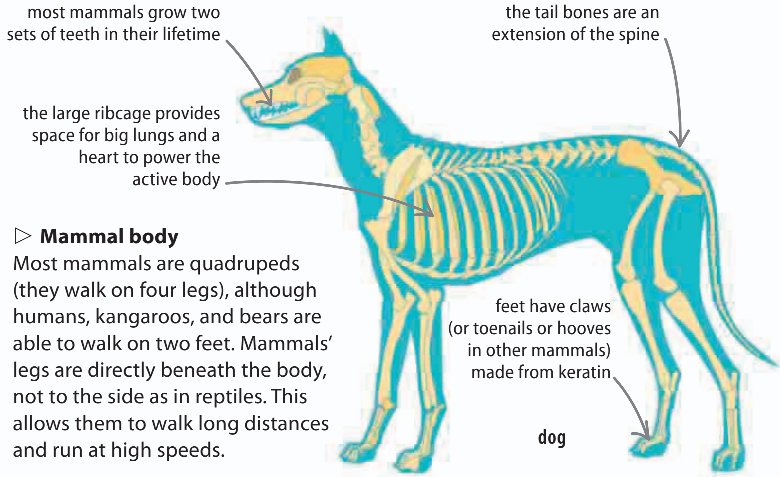
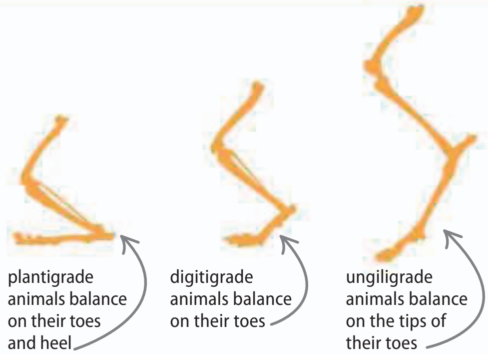


▷ **Mammal body**
Most mammals are quadrupeds (they walk on four legs), although humans, kangaroos, and bears are able to walk on two feet. Mammals' legs are directly beneath the body, not to the side as in reptiles. This allows them to walk long distances and run at high speeds.

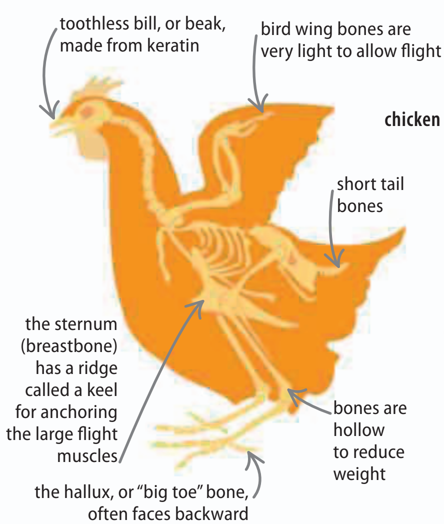


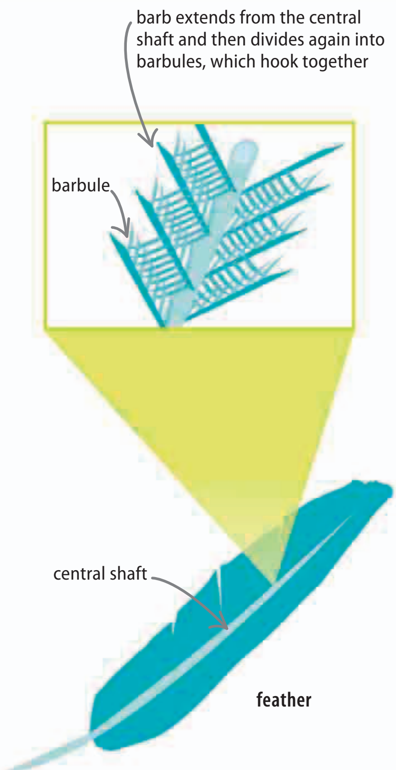
△ **Stances**
Mammals stand in three ways. Animals that walk long distances, such as humans and bears, are plantigrade. Digitigrade feet are used by agile animals that run and jump, such as dogs. Ungiligrade animals, such as horses, are suited to high-speed running.

Birds

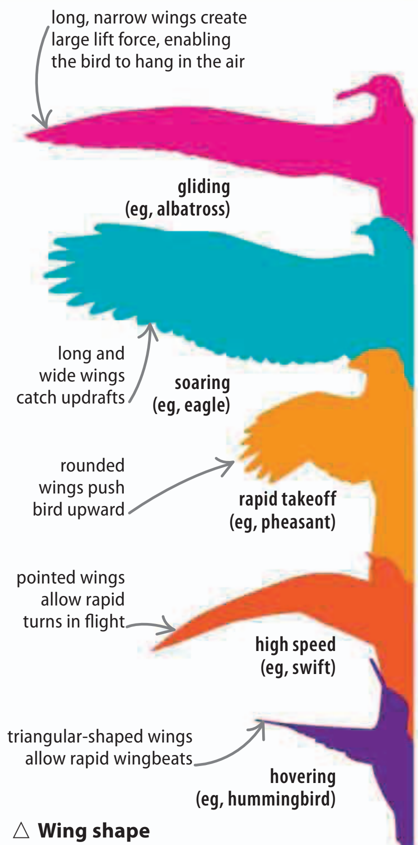
The first birds evolved from forest-living dinosaurs about 150 mya. With about 10,000 species known, birds are the dominant flying vertebrates. Their wings are formed from long feathers attached to the bones of the forelimb. Feathers are stiff but lightweight, making them ideal for forming a rigid flight surface.

▽ **Bird skeleton**
Birds evolved from bipedal (upright-walking) dinosaurs. The wing is formed from the forelimb with thickened finger bones extending from the end to increase the length.





△ **Feather anatomy**
A feather is made of a branching network of hooked keratin filaments. Birds must frequently preen, applying oils that keep the filaments clean and hooked together into a flat surface.



△ **Wing shape**
The shape of a bird's wing is a good indicator of how it flies. Scavenging birds need long, curved wings to glide, while ground birds need short wings to take off and get away from predators quickly.